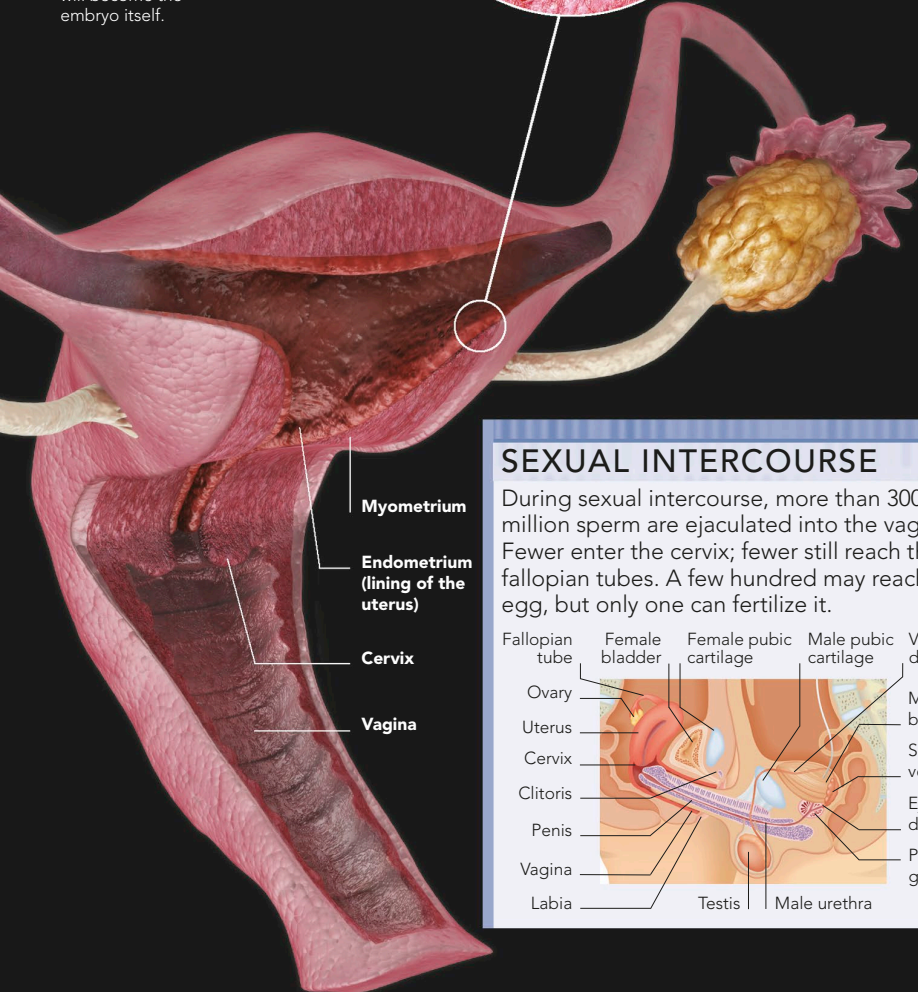
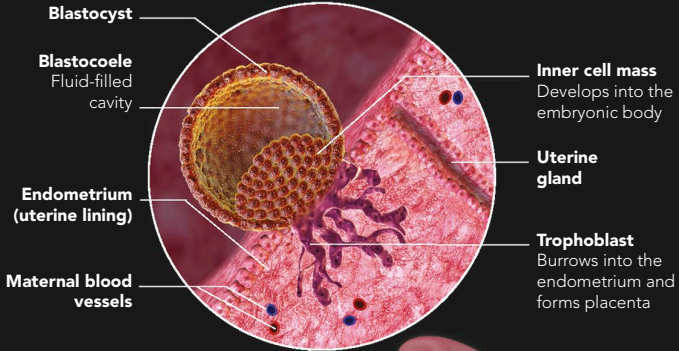


4 BLASTOCYST

About six days after fertilization, the cell cluster forms a hollow cavity and is known as a blastocyst. It floats within the uterus for around 48 hours before landing on the thick uterus lining (endometrium), which softens to aid implantation (burrowing of the blastocyst into the endometrium). The inner group of cells will become the embryo itself.



SEXUAL INTERCOURSE

During sexual intercourse, more than 300 million sperm are ejaculated into the vagina. Fewer enter the cervix; fewer still reach the fallopian tubes. A few hundred may reach the egg, but only one can fertilize it.

